Staff answers & diagnostic guide — Planning the piece: four composition choices

Pathway: TRACK · Week 3 Part 1 · Big question: How do four deliberate choices — focal point, palette, background pattern, and medium — shape an identity piece?

Starter answer & explanation

Question: What happens if your background pattern uses the exact same tone and line thickness as your central motif?

Correct: The central motif gets camouflaged and lost inside the busy background — Exactly. To keep the focal point clear, give it a contrasting tone, thicker border, or calmer halo.

Guided team check (We do) answers

Q1: Why is a limited three-colour palette usually stronger than using twelve random colours? -> A limited palette creates visual harmony and lets dark-against-light contrast stay crystal clear (Yes. Three well-chosen tones unify the whole artwork.)

Q2: How can you stop a bold repeating background pattern from swallowing your main portrait or symbol? -> Use a thicker dark contour or a contrasting tonal halo around the central subject (Spot on. A tonal break or bold outline separates subject from ground.)

Q3: What should your four annotations on the planning sheet explain? -> What each choice is (focal point, pattern, palette, medium) and WHY it suits your piece (Correct. Naming the choice and its visual purpose completes the design brief.)

Exit check answer

Question: What do we call a small, quick sketch used to test layout ideas before starting a final artwork?

Correct: A thumbnail sketch — Correct. Thumbnails let you test and compare layouts in minutes.